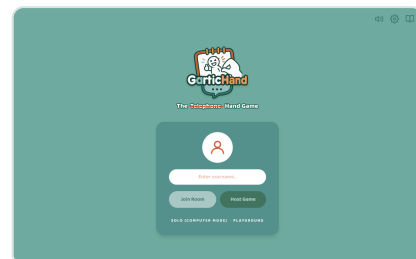


Gartic Hands — New Player Guide

Read time: 5 minutes. Everything you need to play your first game. No mouse, no stylus — you draw in the air with your hand in front of your webcam.

What is Gartic Hands?

Gartic Hands is a multiplayer **drawing-and-guessing game** in the spirit of *Gartic Phone* and the telephone game. Everyone writes a sentence, draws someone else's sentence with **hand gestures tracked by their webcam**, then guesses what someone else drew. At the end the whole chain — sentence → drawing → guess — is revealed, and it is usually hilarious.



You need	Details
A laptop or desktop with a webcam	Built-in is fine
Chrome or Edge	Other browsers are untested
2–4 players	Each on their own device, or in separate windows
Decent light	Tracking works best with your hand clearly lit against a plain background

Quick start (60 seconds)

Host

1. Type a name → Host Game
2. Copy Room Code → send it to friends
3. When everyone is ready → Start Game

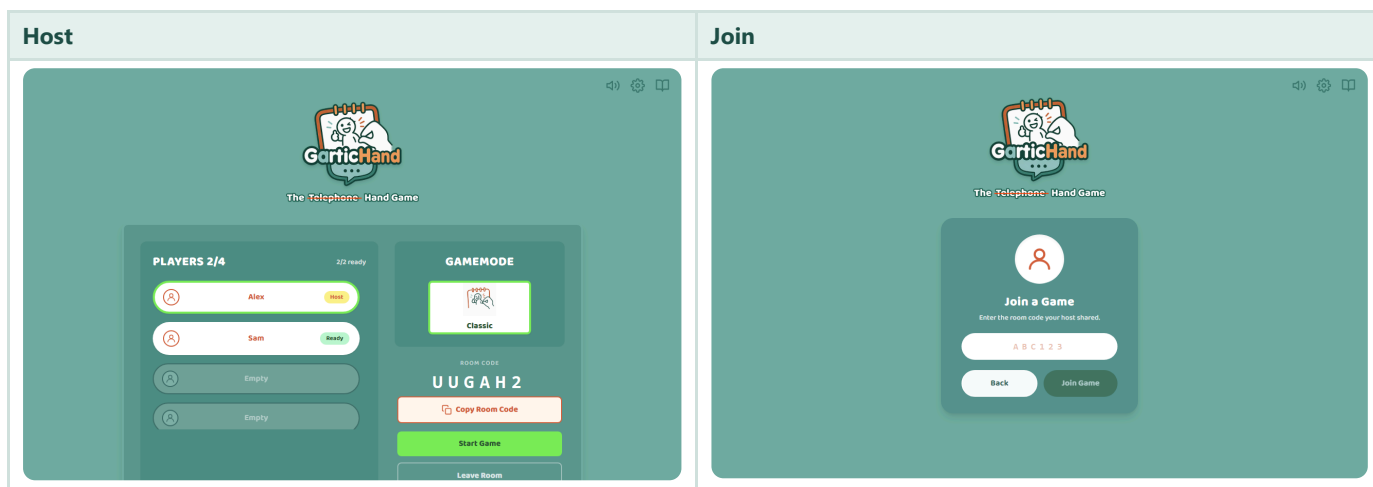
Everyone else

1. Type a name → Join Room
2. Paste the 6-character code → Join Game
3. Press Ready Up

Then every player plays the same four steps: 🖋️ **Write** → 🖐️ **Draw** → 🤔 **Guess** → 🎉 **Reveal**.

Step by step

1 · Host or join a room



- **Host:** enter a name and press **Host Game**. Your lobby shows a 6-character **room code** (e.g. UUGAH2). Press **Copy Room Code** and share it however you like.
- **Join:** enter a name, press **Join Room**, type the code, press **Join Game**.
- Everyone who joins appears in the **Players** list. Joiners press **Ready Up** to turn their badge green; the host is always ready.
- The host's **Start Game** button unlocks only when every player is ready. Anyone can press **Leave Room** at any time.

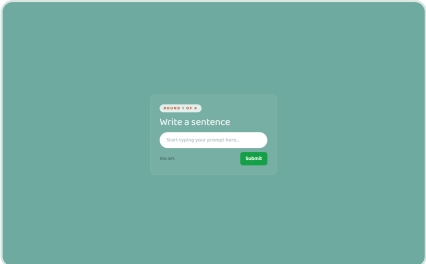
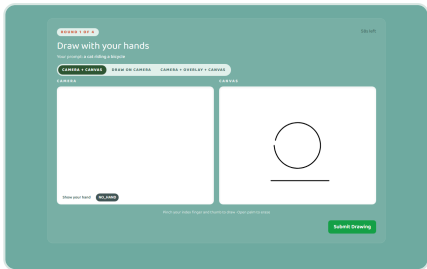

A room disappears about a minute after its last player leaves, and whenever the game server restarts. If a code stops working, ask the host to create a new room.

2 • Write a sentence

Type anything drawable — *"a cat riding a bicycle"*, *"a house on the moon"* — and press **Submit**. You have **60 seconds**; the timer turns red for the last 10. If the timer runs out, whatever you typed is submitted for you (an empty box gets a random prompt).

3 • Draw with your hands

Your browser will ask for **camera permission** the first time — allow it. Then:



Gesture	What it does	Tip
 Pinch index finger and thumb together, then move	Draws a line following your index fingertip	Keep the pinch closed while drawing; open it to lift the pen
 Open palm (all four fingers up) and sweep	Erases wherever your hand passes	Small circles work better than big swipes
 Hand visible, no gesture	Shows a cursor so you can position before drawing	—

The pills in the bottom-left corner of the camera view tell you what the game currently sees — "Show your hand" / "Hand detected", plus the gesture: **NO_HAND**, **HAND_PRESENT**, **PINCH** or **OPEN_PALM**. If it says NO_HAND, move your hand fully into frame and towards the light.

Pick a layout with the tabs above the canvas — **Camera + Canvas** (side by side), **Draw on Camera** (draw straight over your video) or **Camera + Overlay + Canvas**. Press **Submit Drawing** when you are done, or let the 60-second timer submit it for you.

4 • Guess the drawing

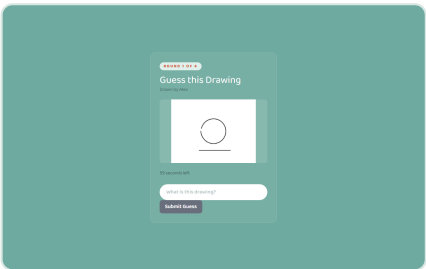
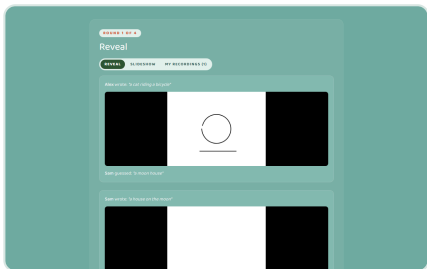
You are shown **another player's** drawing and who drew it. Type your best guess and press **Submit Guess** — 60 seconds again.

5 • The reveal

Once everyone has guessed, the reveal page shows every chain: **who wrote what** → **what was drawn** → **what was guessed**. Three tabs:

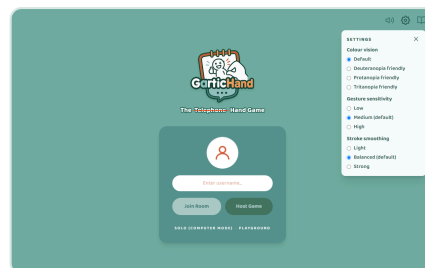
- **Reveal** — all chains as cards.
- **Slideshow** — steps through each chain automatically (every 4 seconds), with Prev / Pause / Next.
- **My Recordings (N)** — a video replay of *your own* drawing phase, camera picture-in-picture included. Recordings stay on your device; nobody else can see them.

The host then presses **Play Round 2** (a game is **4 rounds**), or **Back to Lobby** after the last one.



Settings

Press the **gear icon** (top-right) on the landing page or in the lobby **before** the game starts — it is not available on the drawing screen. Every choice is remembered on your device.



Setting	Options	Choose...
Colour vision	Default · Deuteranopia friendly · Protanopia friendly · Tritanopia friendly	...a palette that is easy for you to read
Gesture sensitivity	Low · Medium (default) · High	High if pinches are not registering; Low if lines start when you did not mean to draw
Stroke smoothing	Light · Balanced (default) · Strong	Strong for calmer lines if your hand shakes; Light for snappier, more precise control

Practice modes

From the landing page you can also open:

- **Solo (Computer Mode)** — draw random prompts on your own. A 60-second clock runs for pacing, but nothing is submitted when it hits zero. **Save + New Prompt** keeps your drawing in an on-page gallery and moves on; **Skip Prompt** moves on without saving. Nothing is sent anywhere.
- **Playground** — a free canvas for testing your camera, lighting and gestures before a real game. **Snapshot** saves what you drew to an on-screen preview.

Try the Playground first if it is your first time — thirty seconds of practice makes the real round much more fun.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Try this
"Failed to start hand tracking" or a black camera box	Close other apps using the webcam (Zoom, Teams), allow the camera permission in the browser's address bar, then reload the page
The pill is stuck on NO_HAND	Face a light source, keep your whole hand in frame, avoid a busy background
Lines appear when you are not pinching	Settings → Gesture sensitivity: Low
Pinches are being ignored	Settings → Gesture sensitivity: High , and pinch more firmly
Lines are wobbly	Settings → Stroke smoothing: Strong
I refreshed the page and got kicked to the start	Expected for now — refreshing leaves the room. Rejoin with the same code; you will sit out the current round and play from the next one
I joined and see "Round N is still being played"	You joined mid-round. Wait for the reveal; you are in from the next round
The room code says invalid	Codes are 6 letters/numbers; rooms expire a minute after everyone leaves or when the server restarts. Ask for a fresh one

Made for FIT3170 by the Gartic Hands team · Source and issues: <https://github.com/Monash-FIT3170/2026W2-GarticHands>